

QA INTERVIEW ACCELERATOR

QA Interview Question Bank

The most common QA interview questions with concise model answers.

Introduction

This question bank collects the questions QA candidates are most commonly asked, with concise model answers. Use it to revise, not to memorise — understand each answer so you can say it in your own words.

How to Use This Bank

- Read each question and try to answer before reading the model.
- Rephrase model answers in your own words.
- Back theory answers with a real example where you can.
- Revisit weak areas until they feel natural.

Testing Fundamentals

What is the difference between verification and validation?

Verification asks "are we building it right?" (reviews, static checks against spec). Validation asks "are we building the right thing?" (executing the product against user needs).

What is the difference between QA, QC and testing?

QA is process-focused (preventing defects); QC is product-focused (finding defects in the product); testing is the activity of executing/examining the product to find defects and provide information.

What is the difference between severity and priority?

Severity is the technical impact of a defect; priority is how urgently it should be fixed from a business view. A typo on the homepage can be low severity but high priority.

What is the difference between a test case and a test scenario?

A scenario is a high-level "what to test"; a test case is the detailed steps, data and expected result for verifying it.

What is the STLC?

The Software Testing Life Cycle: requirement analysis, test planning, test case design, environment setup, test execution, and test closure.

When do you stop testing?

When exit criteria are met: planned coverage achieved, critical defects resolved, risk acceptable to stakeholders, and time/budget constraints reached — it is a risk-based decision, not "no bugs left".

Test Design Techniques

What is equivalence partitioning?

Dividing inputs into groups that should behave the same, then testing one value per group to reduce cases while keeping coverage.

What is boundary value analysis?

Testing at the edges of input ranges (min, max, just inside/outside) because defects cluster at boundaries.

When would you use a decision table?

When behaviour depends on combinations of conditions/rules — it ensures every combination is considered.

What is state transition testing?

Testing how a system moves between states and whether valid/invalid transitions behave correctly (e.g. login attempts → locked account).

What is the difference between positive and negative testing?

Positive testing checks the system works with valid input; negative testing checks it handles invalid input gracefully.

Defects & Reporting

What makes a good bug report?

A clear specific title, environment, minimal numbered steps to reproduce, expected vs actual results, evidence, and a justified severity/priority.

A developer says "cannot reproduce" — what do you do?

Re-verify on a clean environment, confirm exact build/data/steps, add evidence (video/logs), and pair with them — focus on the issue, not blame.

What is the defect life cycle?

New → Assigned → Open/In progress → Fixed → Retest → Closed (or Reopened/Deferred/Rejected as applicable).

Agile & Process

How does testing fit into Agile?

Testing is continuous and collaborative: testers get involved at refinement, test stories as they are built, and contribute across ceremonies rather than acting as an end gate.

What are the three amigos?

Business (PO), development and testing discussing a story together before build to clarify requirements and acceptance criteria early.

What is the difference between smoke and regression testing?

Smoke testing is a quick check that core functions work (build is testable); regression confirms existing functionality still works after changes.

Technical (API, SQL, Automation, AI)

What is API testing and why is it valuable?

Testing the application layer directly (requests/responses) — it is faster, more stable and can catch issues before the UI exists.

What does a status code like 200, 400, 401, 404 or 500 mean?

200 success; 400 bad request; 401 unauthorised; 404 not found; 500 server error.

Why do testers need SQL?

To verify data is stored/updated correctly, set up test data, and investigate issues at the database level.

When should a test be automated?

When it is repetitive, stable, high-value and run often (e.g. regression, smoke) — not for one-off or rapidly changing exploratory checks.

How do you use AI responsibly in testing?

As a drafting/assisting tool: never paste sensitive data, always verify output against reality, and stay personally accountable for the result.

Common Mistakes

- Memorising wording instead of understanding.
- Giving theory with no example.
- Rambling — keep answers tight and structured.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

For any "what is the difference between..." question, define both terms in one line each, then give a quick example. That structure instantly sounds confident and clear.